



CMD'S REPUBLIC DAY MESSAGE

26TH JANUARY 2021



**Good morning,
friends and colleagues,**

I convey my heartiest regards to all of you as India celebrates its 72nd Republic Day. As we all know, our Constitution came into effect on 26th January, 1950, thus ushering in an

Independent Republic. We are, yet again, on the cusp of liberation – this time, from the grip of COVID-19 to a dawn of new hope and healing, as the country embarks on the world's greatest vaccination drive to control the virus outbreak that has disrupted lives and livelihoods.

As India gets propelled into a phase of rapid industrial recovery in the post-pandemic world, the mining sector will have a pivotal role to play with its multiplier effect in terms of GDP contribution. The demand of Copper is also expected to spiral up in the coming years with the recent thrust on green technology and digitalisation. Clean energy is the fastest growing segment to support electrification, with solar panels and wind turbines requiring around 12 times more Copper than previous generation methods. Electric vehicles use four times the amount of Copper used in internal combustion engines. The 5G network which is regarded as the optimal choice for industry digitization will also require many more tons of Copper. Further, COVID-19 has brought Copper to the forefront of the healthcare industry due to its unique antimicrobial properties, thereby adding entirely a new dimension to its use.

Thus, as a key input for manufacturing, electrical equipment, industrial machinery and construction, India will need more Copper for its economic recovery. As a major step towards import substitution and reducing the nation's dependence on imported Copper concentrate, HCL has signed a Memorandum of Understanding with Hindalco for the long-term purchase and sale of Copper concentrate. This unique Public-Private Partnership (PPP) aligns with the Government's clarion call for Aatma Nirbhar Bharat Abhiyan. Recently, despite

the raging pandemic, Malanjkhand Copper Project has achieved the milestone of connecting 240 level from both the North and South declines at its Underground Mine Project, a step that takes it closer to its targeted ore production of 5 MTPA.

Further, HCL is adopting a number of strategic measures for sustained growth and development. The Company is in the process of appointing an MDO for mining and beneficiation for the underground mines at Rakha and Chapri in Indian Copper Complex. Tolling of Cathodes into Continuous Cast Wire Rods will also be stepped up for interested partners at Taloja Copper Project.

Owing to the pandemic and other allied hurdles, 2020 has drawn to an end with targets unmet. Hence, the need of the hour is to stay focussed on our goals and responsibilities with a strong sense of accountability. Timely implementation of our mine expansion plan along with meeting the production targets and strict compliance to the required quality standards are essential for survival of the Company. I solicit each member of the Copper Family to work with dedication and self-imposed discipline. Meanwhile, my heart goes out to our COVID warriors who have put in their best efforts and kept their spirits high, despite all odds.

Together we have braved many challenges. In sync with the innate quality of Copper to endure, it is inherent in the nature of our Copper Family to withstand the struggle for existence and to survive. With our collective zeal and a fire deep within, come let us pave the way to success and dedicate ourselves in the service of the nation.

Wishing you all a very Happy Republic Day. Jai Hind.

A. Shukla

(Arun Kumar Shukla)

**Chairman and Managing Director
January 26, 2021**